STRATEGIC IMPERATIVES

Executive Leader Conversation Guide

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How to Use This Guide

A practical guide for encouraging reflection, discussion and dialogue about what the Strategic Imperatives mean for the team and day-to-day work.

PURPOSE Help executive leaders move from communicating the Strategic Imperatives to facilitating a focused conversation that creates shared meaning, local relevance and visible action.

What this guide helps leaders do

1. Prepare for the Conversation

Use the executive cascade deck as the enterprise anchor. The conversation guide provides the instructions, prompts and follow-through needed to make the message relevant to the team.

Before the session

- **Know the audience.** Consider what the team already knows, what may be unclear and what connection would be most useful.
- **Select local examples.** Prepare two or three current examples that show the imperatives in a priority, decision, behavior or outcome.
- **Choose the discussion focus.** Decide whether the team needs to discuss all four imperatives briefly or explore one or two in greater depth.
- **Anticipate questions.** Identify areas where employees may need context, clarification or follow-up.
- **Prepare a visible commitment.** Decide what the team should see or hear from you after the conversation.
- **Plan the follow-through.** Choose when and where commitments or unresolved questions will be revisited.

Preparation worksheet

Preparation item	Leader notes
Audience	Who will participate, and what do they most need to understand?
Local example 1	Which current priority or decision best illustrates an imperative?
Local example 2	Which behavior or outcome should the team connect to?
Discussion focus	Which imperative and reflection question will generate the most useful dialogue?

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Preparation item	Leader notes
My visible commitment	What will the team see or hear from me?
Follow-up point	When and where will progress or open questions be revisited?

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2. Open and Frame the Conversation

SUGGESTED OPENING "Today is an opportunity to connect our mission and Strategic Imperatives to the work of our team. I will provide the enterprise context, but I also want to hear your perspective on where the imperatives are already visible, where we have opportunities to strengthen alignment and what they should mean for our day-to-day choices."

Establish the "why"

- Our mission remains constant. The Strategic Imperatives focus how Orlando Health delivers the mission.
- The imperatives create shared focus across the enterprise.
- The imperatives guide priorities, decisions and trade-offs.
- The imperatives connect leadership behavior and daily work to outcomes.
- The imperatives are an enterprise leadership and decision framework, not four unrelated initiatives.

Set expectations for dialogue

- This is a conversation, not a test. There is no expectation that every person will use the same words.
- The focus is on understanding, practical connection and what should be visible in the work.
- Different perspectives are useful. The leader will listen for common themes and areas needing follow-up.
- The conversation will close with one action or commitment, not a long list of ideas.

Opening questions

- "What stands out to you as you hear the four Strategic Imperatives?"
- "Which imperative feels most connected to our team's work right now?"
- "Where do you already see the imperatives showing up in our priorities or decisions?"

FACILITATION CUE Pause for a few seconds after asking a question. Invite two or three responses, then summarize the common thread before continuing.

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3. Use a Four-Move Conversation

Use the following sequence to keep the discussion focused. Ask one question at a time and move from meaning to application.

1. REFLECT | Allow individuals to form a point of view before discussion.

Leader language: *"Take a moment to consider where this imperative is already visible in our work and where the connection may be less clear."*

- Allow a brief pause.
- Invite people to write down one thought if helpful.
- Do not fill the silence too quickly.

2. DISCUSS | Surface perspectives, questions and differences in experience.

Leader language: *"What does this imperative mean for our team and the work we do?"*

- Invite two or three responses.
- Ask for an example when a response is broad.
- Acknowledge different perspectives without debating each point.

3. CONNECT | Translate meaning into priorities, decisions, behaviors and outcomes.

Leader language: *"What should this change or reinforce in the way we prioritize, decide and work?"*

- Use a current local example.
- Ask what others would see or experience.
- Identify barriers or opportunities that deserve follow-up.

4. COMMIT | Convert dialogue into a visible next action.

Leader language: *"Based on this discussion, what is one thing we should do differently or more consistently?"*

- Name the action or behavior.
- Clarify ownership.
- State where the commitment will be revisited.

LISTEN AND SYNTHESIZE Use language such as: "What I am hearing is…," "The connection to our work is…," and "The area we need to strengthen is…."

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4. Discussion Prompts by Strategic Imperative

Demand Excellence in All We Do

Enterprise meaning: Demonstrate the highest level of performance in quality, patient care and economics.

Choose one primary question and one probe:

- "Where must we raise or more consistently reinforce the standard?"
- "Where is the standard clear, and where may expectations be inconsistent?"
- "What would patients, partners or team members notice if we improved?"
- "What tools, training or accountability would help people meet the standard?"

Possible synthesis: *"The connection I hear is that excellence must be visible in both the outcomes we deliver and the way we enable people to deliver them."*

Partner with Physicians

Enterprise meaning: Create meaningful partnerships grounded in trust and credibility.

Choose one primary question and one probe:

- "Where could earlier physician engagement strengthen a decision or outcome?"
- "What would meaningful partnership look like at the beginning of the work?"
- "Where could greater transparency improve trust or follow-through?"
- "What perspective should be included before we move forward?"

Possible synthesis: *"The opportunity is to engage physician perspectives earlier, communicate trade-offs clearly and strengthen credibility through follow-through."*

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4. Discussion Prompts by Strategic Imperative

Be the Best Place to Work

Enterprise meaning: Promote a culture that values individuals, and teamwork that results in organizational pride.

Choose one primary question and one probe:

- "What leadership behavior would most strengthen the team experience?"
- "What should team members see, hear or experience more consistently?"
- "Where would greater role clarity or cross-team coordination help?"
- "How can we invite feedback and respond with transparency?"

Possible synthesis: *"The team experience is shaped by everyday leadership behaviors, especially clarity, respect, teamwork, feedback and recognition."*

Drive Growth and Innovation

Enterprise meaning: Execute on opportunities to create sustainable competitive advantage.

Choose one primary question and one probe:

- "What opportunity could create greater value for those we serve?"
- "What assumption or conventional approach may be worth re-examining?"
- "Where could a new idea, model of care or way of working improve value?"
- "What would help us evaluate and scale promising improvements?"

Possible synthesis: *"Growth and innovation should extend the mission, create sustainable value and improve how we care and work."*

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5. Connect the Imperatives to Day-to-Day Work

Use four practical lenses to help the team move from broad agreement to specific implications. The leader may use all four lenses or select the two most relevant to the current conversation.

Lens	Discussion question	Useful follow-up
PRIORITIES	What should receive focus, time or resources?	What may need to receive less attention so that this can be prioritized?
DECISIONS	How should the imperatives guide choices or trade-offs?	Which imperative provides the clearest lens for this decision?
BEHAVIORS	What should leaders and teams do consistently?	What would people see or hear if this behavior were strong?
OUTCOMES	How will patients, physicians, team members or communities experience the difference?	What evidence would tell us the imperative is becoming real?

Use local examples without changing the enterprise message

- Start with: "For us, this means…"
- Name a current priority, decision, behavior or outcome the team recognizes.
- Make the connection to a specific imperative explicit.
- Keep the example brief enough to invite discussion rather than redirect the session into a project update.

EXAMPLE LANGUAGE "For us, demanding excellence means using quality and experience data to focus improvement where it matters most."

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6. Manage Common Conversation Moments

If the room is quiet

- Offer a second concrete example, then ask: "Where else do you see this in our work?"
- Allow 30 seconds for individual reflection before inviting responses.
- Ask for a choice: "Which lens matters most right now: priorities, decisions, behaviors or outcomes?"
- Invite one person to build on the example rather than asking broadly for "any thoughts."

If the discussion becomes too broad

- Refocus: "Let's bring this back to what this means for our team and the work within our influence."
- Ask: "Which priority, decision, behavior or outcome does this connect to?"
- Capture important topics that require a separate discussion.

If concern or disagreement surfaces

- Acknowledge the perspective without becoming defensive.
- Clarify what is known and what requires follow-up.
- Ask what the concern means for successful implementation or alignment.
- Avoid resolving complex operational issues during the cascade conversation.

If a question cannot be answered

SUGGESTED RESPONSE "That is an important question. I do not want to speculate. I will capture it, confirm the appropriate information and bring the answer back through [specific forum or communication]."

Avoid these patterns

- Reading every slide word for word.
- Asking broad questions such as "Any thoughts?"
- Requiring every person to speak.
- Debating each comment or solving every issue in the moment.
- Creating a long list of commitments without clear ownership.
- Changing the enterprise meaning of an imperative to fit a local example.

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7. Close with Commitment and Follow-Through

Synthesize what you heard

- "What I am hearing is…"
- "The strongest connection to our work is…"
- "The opportunity for us is…"
- "The behavior that needs to be more visible is…"

Confirm one visible commitment

TEAM COMMITMENT STATEMENT "For our team, this imperative means we will _____ so that _____."

- Make the action observable and within the team's influence.
- Name who owns the next step.
- Clarify what success or progress will look like.
- State when and where the team will revisit the commitment.

Suggested close

"The Strategic Imperatives give us a shared language and focus. Their value will be determined by how consistently we use them to guide priorities, decisions, behaviors and outcomes. Based on today's conversation, you will see us _____. We will revisit this commitment in _____."

Final leader check

☐ Can the team explain why the Strategic Imperatives matter?

☐ Can the team identify where the imperatives connect to day-to-day work?

☐ Did the conversation surface a useful example, barrier or opportunity?

☐ Is there one clear action or leadership behavior that will be visible next?

☐ Is follow-up ownership clear?

LEADER REMINDER The communication is credible when team members can see the connection in leadership choices, actions, sponsorship and follow-through.

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